

PROJECT REPORT

KaalSync

Sync Your Time, Unlock Your Focus

Customer Discovery, Research, Wireframes & Prototype

Team Members

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1. Executive Summary

Students and recent graduates consistently struggle to manage coursework, jobs, applications, and personal responsibilities, and existing calendar and to-do apps have not solved the problem. The KaalSync team set out to understand why, using a 39-respondent survey and six in-depth interviews across a range of student and early-career profiles.

The research surfaced a consistent pattern: people are not failing because they lack tools, but because their tools do not adapt to how their time actually behaves. Fragmented calendars across Google, Outlook, and school platforms, unpredictable free time between commitments, and rigid apps that assume a fixed routine all compound the stress reported by over 74% of survey respondents (a stress rating of 3 or higher out of 5).

KaalSync addresses this by unifying multiple calendars into a single view and actively surfacing free time between commitments, rather than leaving the user to find and plan around it manually. The concept was developed through wireframes for both web and mobile, and has since been carried into a working prototype that demonstrates the core gap-detection and task-tracking features described in this report.

2. Problem Statement & Customer Discovery

The team chose time management among students and recent graduates as its focus area. Balancing coursework, part-time jobs, job applications, internships, and personal responsibilities is often overwhelming, and it leads to stress and inefficiency. Recent graduates face the added complexity of adapting to workplace expectations while balancing personal life and professional growth. The topic is universal and relatable: every team member has experienced these struggles directly, which shaped both the interview approach and the eventual product direction.

Recurring Themes from Early Interviews

- Difficulty figuring out which tasks to prioritize.
- Ongoing struggles with distraction and procrastination.
- A sense of being stuck in a loop, with no clear way to manage tasks effectively.
- Compromising social life and health to keep up with commitments and avoid missing out.
- Frustration that current apps are complicated to use, when what people want is something simpler.

Representative Interview Questions

- What strategies have you developed to stay on top of your commitments and deadlines?
- Are there certain times of day when you feel most, or least, productive?
- Do you use any tools (apps, planners, calendars) to organize your schedule? How do they help?
- What situation usually causes you to lose track of time and feel stressed?
- How do you personally define successful time management?

3. Research Methodology

The team combined a structured survey with in-depth interviews to triangulate quantitative patterns and qualitative context.

- Survey: distributed to students and recent graduates, reaching 39 respondents.
- In-depth interviews: six one-on-one interviews spanning different profiles, including an international PhD student who started managing time late, a graduate student nearing completion, an undergraduate juggling multiple commitments, a recent graduate now working full-time, and two additional students dealing with perfectionism and social pressure.
- Analysis: frequency counts of survey responses, categorization of common challenges, a process map built from interview data, a categorized problem list, and a user persona with an accompanying journey map.

4. Survey Findings

Across 39 respondents, spanning undergraduate, graduate, and other academic levels, the data pointed to consistent, high stress around time management and heavy reliance on informal tools that are not solving the problem.

Respondent Breakdown

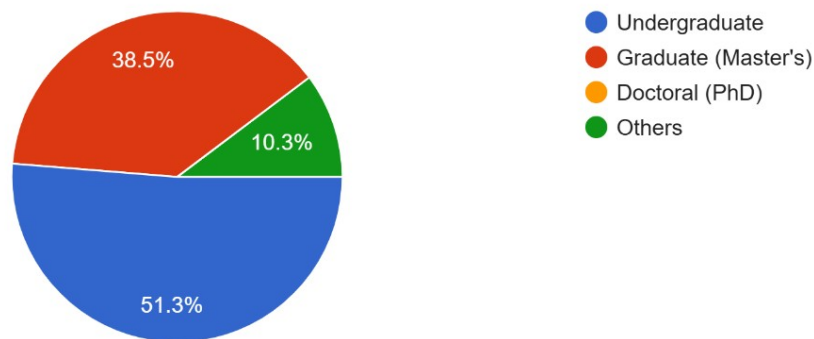


Fig. 1 — Respondent academic level (n = 39): 51.3% undergraduate, 38.5% graduate (master's), 10.3% other.

Stress Due to Time Management (Scale of 1–5)

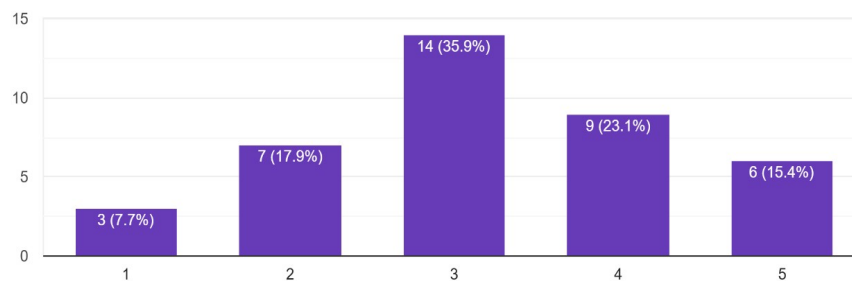


Fig. 2 — 35.9% of respondents rated their time-management stress a 3/5, and 38.5% rated it a 4 or 5, showing stress is the norm, not the exception.

Tools and Techniques in Use

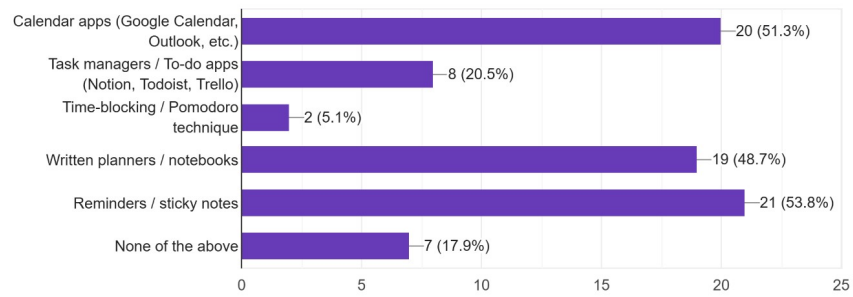


Fig. 3 — Reminders/sticky notes (53.8%) and calendar apps (51.3%) are the most common tools, ahead of dedicated task managers (20.5%) and time-blocking techniques (5.1%) — people default to low-effort tools, not planning systems.

Top Self-Reported Challenge

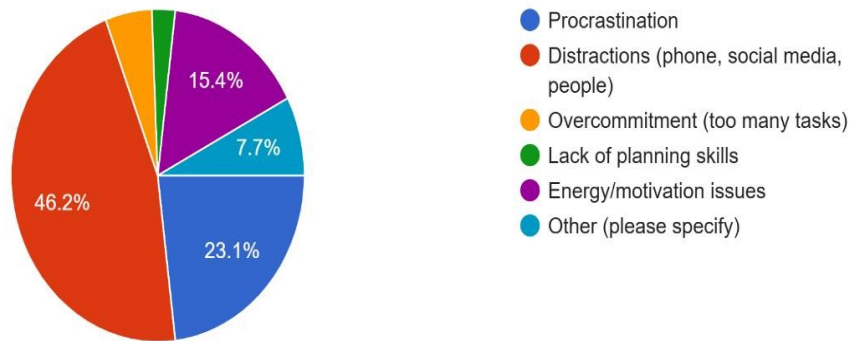


Fig. 4 — Distractions (phone, social media, people) are the single biggest reported challenge at 46.2%, well ahead of procrastination (23.1%).

5. Categorized Problem List

Survey responses were grouped into five recurring problem categories:

- Distractions (top challenge): phone, social media, and peers fragment focus.
- Procrastination & motivation issues: tasks are often left to the last minute, with low motivation for routine work.
- Overcommitment & workload: juggling classes, jobs, and internships leads to stress and missed deadlines.
- Poor sleep & energy management: late nights create next-day fatigue and reduce the ability to sustain focus.
- Planning & execution gaps: tools like calendars and planners exist but are not used effectively or systematically.

6. Qualitative Insights from Interviews

The six in-depth interviews surfaced a deeper pattern behind the survey numbers: time management is not one problem, it is at least three problems that get treated as one.

Tools Work Until They Don't

The issue is rarely the app itself. It is a mismatch between what tools demand (consistent input, rigid categories, daily maintenance) and what people can realistically give (changing priorities, day-to-day chaos). When a tool's requirements outpace a person's capacity to maintain it, they stop using it.

Structure vs. Chaos

Some people need rigid schedules to stay focused and calm; others feel suffocated by that same structure and do better with flexibility. Most people actually want something in between, some organization without losing spontaneity, but most tools force a choice between the two extremes.

The Awareness Gap

People typically do not know what time-management approach works for them until they have tried and failed multiple times. That self-awareness takes years to build through trial and error, and current tools do not accelerate it.

Life Stage Transitions

What works in college does not carry over to the workplace. Fixed routines get imposed by a job, flexibility disappears, and there is little guidance on how to adapt a personal system as life stage changes.

Not Everyone Optimizes for the Same Thing

FOMO is not universal. Some people feel real regret about missing events; others make conscious trade-offs and do not think twice. A solution that assumes everyone wants to maximize their calendar misreads a meaningful share of users.

7. Process Map & Failure Points

Interview data was used to map the typical path from receiving a task or commitment to completing it, revealing where the process breaks down.

Process Map- Interview Based

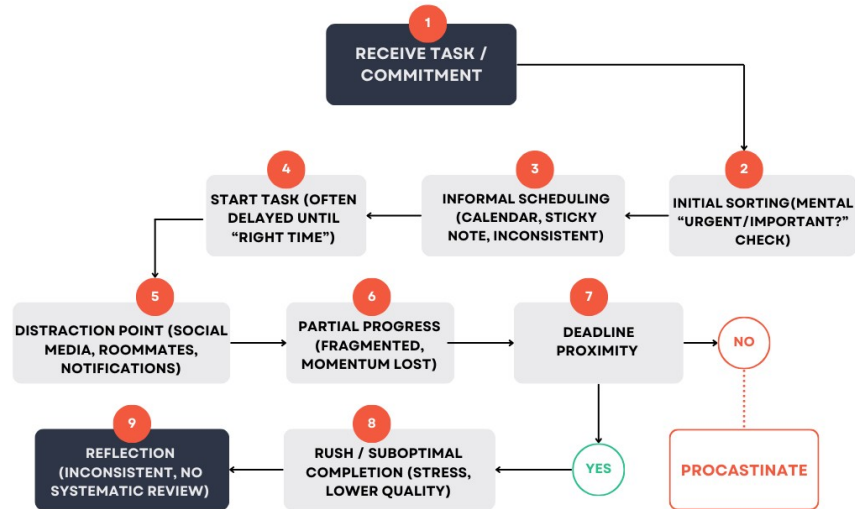


Fig. 5 — Process map built from interview data: task intake through completion and reflection.

Where the Process Breaks Down

- Initial overwhelm (steps 1–3): without a sense of how long tasks take, users cannot reliably sort what is urgent or important, so early scheduling becomes guesswork.
- Mid-load crunch (steps 3–4): informal scheduling (calendars, sticky notes) works when workload is light, but collapses once volume increases, leaving tasks in a state of partial, fragmented progress.
- The distraction trap (steps 5–8): even after starting a task, phone and social media pull attention away, and the resulting lost time forces a rushed, lower-quality finish near the deadline, not because of a bad plan but because time bled away throughout the day.

8. Persona & Journey Map

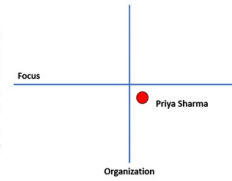
Research findings were synthesized into a primary persona, Ananya Jha, representing the core user KaalSync is designed around.

Persona : Ananya Jha



"I plan my work, but distractions and procrastination keep getting in the way."
- Ananya

Ananya Jha, a 23-year-old graduate student, struggles to balance coursework, part-time work, and job applications. While she uses tools like Google Calendar and planners, her organization is inconsistent, and she often procrastinates or becomes distracted by her phone and social media. Working late into the night helps her catch up, but it creates fatigue and stress, leaving her feeling overcommitted and unproductive. Priya needs a simple, reliable way to stay focused, manage her commitments, and start tasks earlier without sacrificing her well-being.



Goals:

- Stay on top of coursework and deadlines.
- Manage time between school, work, and personal commitments.
- Build consistency in productivity.

Frustrations/Pain Points:

- Easily distracted, leads to lost focus.
- Tends to procrastinate despite using planning tools.
- Energy/motivation dips after long days.
- Overcommits to too many tasks.
- Stress builds before deadlines.

HOW MIGHT WE...?

Distraction

-help her reduce digital distractions while studying?
-design her environment to promote sustained focus?

Procrastination

-make it easier for her to start tasks earlier?
-transform overwhelming assignments into approachable steps?

Overcommitment

-help her realistically prioritize commitments and say no when needed?
-give her a clearer overview of her workload to prevent overload?

Fig. 6 — Persona: Ananya Jha, a 23-year-old graduate student balancing coursework, part-time work, and job applications.

	MORNING	MIDDAY(CLASSES +WORK)	AFTERNOON	EVENING	NIGHT
ACTIVITY	Wakes up tired from late-night studying.	Attends lectures, part-time job, squeezes in internship prep. Chaotic Day!	Studies or works on assignments.	Tries to finish assignments. Rush - Anxious mood	Pushes work into late hours.
PAIN POINT	Lack of energy leads to slow start. Dull Day Start!	Distractions during lectures, multitasking leads to shallow work.	Low motivation, drifts to social media.	Overcommitment leads to juggling multiple tasks at once.	Procrastination leads to sleep delay. Stress rises near deadlines. Compromise health!
OPPORTUNITY	Better sleep routines, morning planning rituals.	Structured focus sessions (Pomodoro, no-phone zones).	Use time-blocking, accountability partner, or productivity apps.	Prioritization framework (urgent/important matrix).	Deadline reminders, reward-based task completion.

Fig. 7 — Persona journey map: activities, pain points, and opportunities from morning through night.

9. Concept Overview: The KaalSync Solution



KaalSync empowers students and professionals to manage their focus and schedules by integrating multiple calendars into a single, unified, intuitive platform. Rather than asking users to adopt a rigid new system, KaalSync connects the calendars people already use (Google, Outlook, Notion, Canvas), tracks tasks alongside those calendars, and actively surfaces free time between commitments so users can decide how to spend it.

This design responds directly to the research: it removes the burden of manual cross-calendar checking (addressing planning and execution gaps), meets users partway between rigid structure and full flexibility (addressing the structure-vs-chaos tension), and uses in-the-moment prompts rather than requiring daily upkeep (addressing the tool-person mismatch).

10. Web App Wireframes

The web experience centers on a unified dashboard: connected calendars, task management, and a calendar view are all visible at once, with a dedicated Calendar Sync view for finding time gaps across multiple connected calendars.

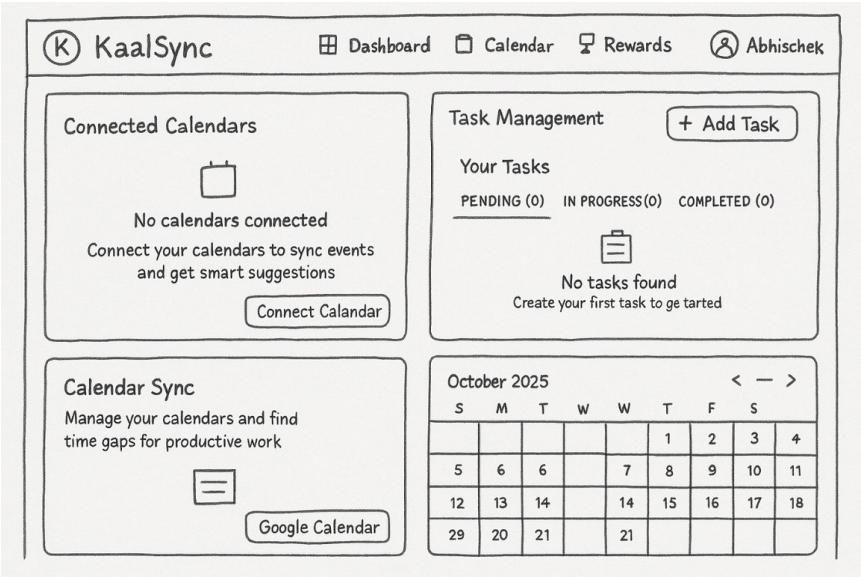


Fig. 8 — Web dashboard wireframe: connected calendars, task management, and calendar overview.

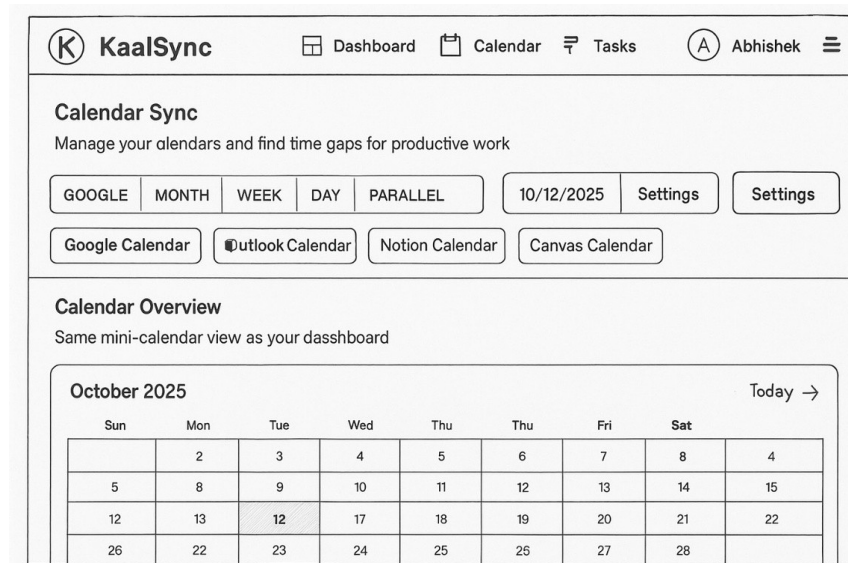
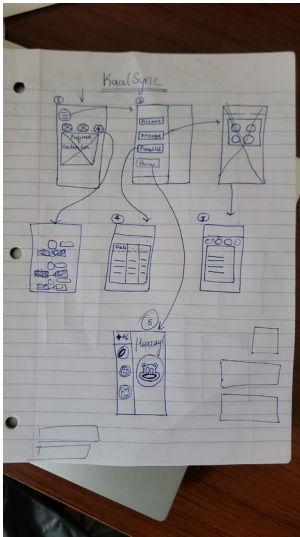


Fig. 9 — Calendar Sync wireframe: multi-calendar view (Google, Outlook, Notion, Canvas) with month/week/day/parallel modes.

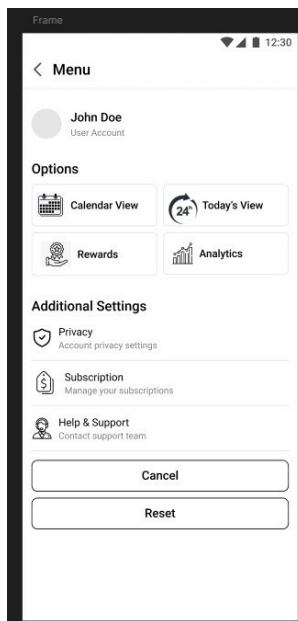
KaalSync connects all of a user's calendars, lets them add and track tasks, and surfaces insight through analytics, rewards, and motivational prompts. Together, these features reduce chaos, boost motivation, and help users build productive habits from a single platform.

11. Mobile App Wireframes

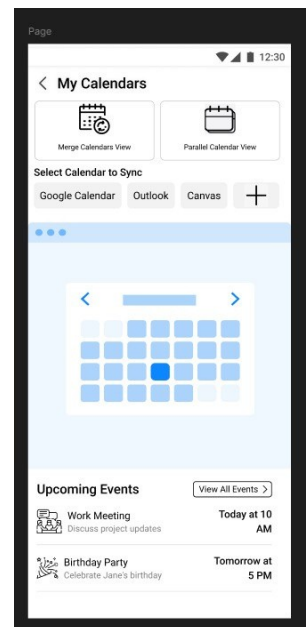
The mobile experience was scoped from an initial hand-drawn wireframe through to a dashboard and calendar view, keeping the same core functions, connected calendars, tasks, and gap visibility, in a compact, on-the-go format.



Hand-drawn wireframe



Dashboard / menu



Calendar view

The dashboard menu gives users quick access to calendar view, today's view, rewards, and analytics, plus account-level settings. The calendar view lets users merge or view calendars in parallel, and surfaces upcoming events directly below the monthly grid.

12. Working Prototype

Beyond wireframes, the team built a working prototype implementing the core features validated by the research: multi-calendar connection, task tracking, and, most directly tied to the research insight about unused free time, automatic gap detection between scheduled events.

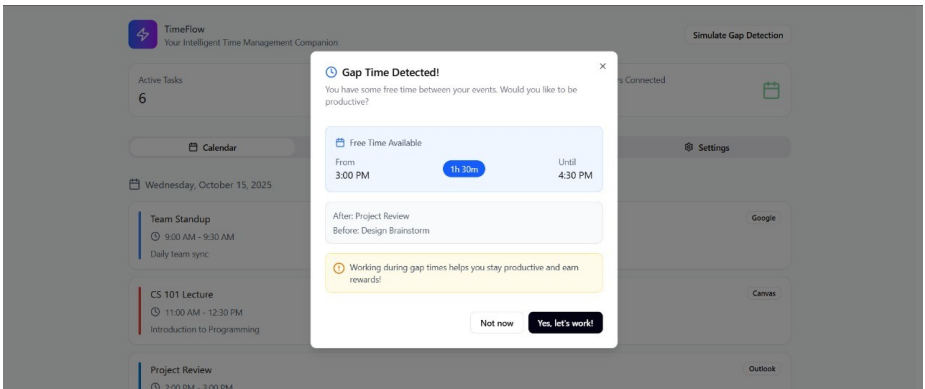


Fig. 10 — Working prototype dashboard, showing connected calendars (Google, Canvas, Outlook) and an active gap-detection prompt.

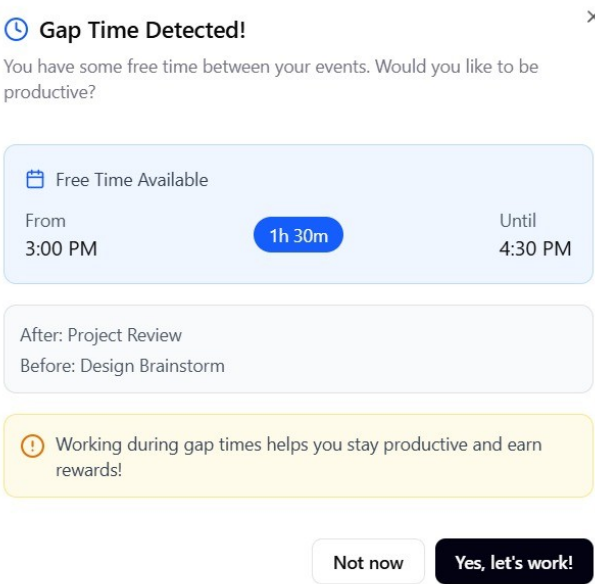


Fig. 11 — Gap Time Detected: the prototype identifies a 1h 30m window between the Project Review and Design Brainstorm events and prompts the user to use it productively.

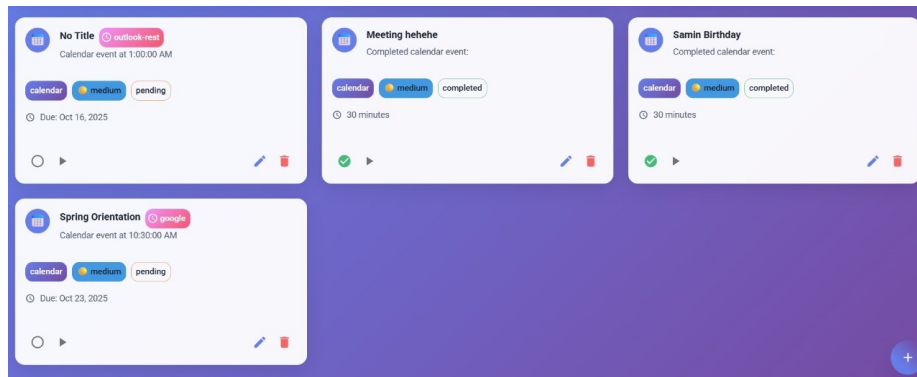


Fig. 12 — Task and calendar-event cards, showing status (pending/completed), priority, and source calendar (Google, Outlook) in a single unified view.

This directly answers the top research finding: rather than requiring users to notice and plan around free time themselves, the system surfaces it automatically and prompts action, closing the planning-and-execution gap identified in both the survey and the interviews.

13. Conclusion & Next Steps

The research consistently showed that time-management struggles are less about missing tools and more about a mismatch between rigid systems and the reality of a student's or graduate's day: fragmented calendars, unpredictable free time, and tools that demand more upkeep than people can sustain. KaalSync's core bet, unifying calendars and surfacing gap time automatically, is a direct response to that finding, and the working prototype demonstrates that the core mechanic is feasible.

- Usability testing of the gap-detection flow with the six original interview participants to validate whether the prompt genuinely changes behavior.
- Expanding calendar integrations beyond Google, Outlook, and Canvas to cover the tools mentioned in the survey (Notion, Todoist, Trello).
- Refining the rewards and analytics features referenced in the wireframes, which were not yet reflected in the current prototype.
- Piloting with a small cohort across the life-stage range identified in research (undergraduate, graduate, working professional) to test whether the system adapts as intended.